

INTERNAL

MEETING TRANSCRIPTION

MEETING DETAILS

Date:	February 1, 2026
Classification:	Internal
Document ID:	TRANS-20260201-160839

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The meeting was convened to discuss the interface between Publican and Ghana Link. The main focus was on the data flow between the two entities and the challenges they had been facing. Publican had been connected to Ghana Link's old data center, which caused delays in data transmission. However, from January, Publican was connected to Ghana Link's new data center, which improved the data flow. The meeting also discussed the return data from Publican to Ghana Link and the need for some minor fixes. The meeting concluded with the decision to allow Publican and Ghana Link to have their internal meetings and then reconvene later to confirm if everything has been set up correctly.

KEY DECISIONS

- Publican and Ghana Link will work together to connect to the new data center.
- The data structure will be agreed upon to send data in real time.
- Minor fixes will be done within the next 30 minutes.
- The return data will be presented to CTSV for assessment and later to the inspection officers and various MDAs.

ACTION ITEMS

	Task Description	Responsible Person	Deadline	Priority	
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	Connect Publican to new data center	Ghana Link	ASAP	High	
	Agree on data structure	Publican & Ghana Link	ASAP	High	
	Fix minor issues	Dr. Kobi	Within 30 minutes	High	
	Present return data to CTSV	Publican	TBD	Medium	

NEXT STEPS

- - Publican and Ghana Link should have their internal meetings to resolve any remaining issues.
- - A follow-up meeting should be scheduled to confirm if everything has been set up correctly.
- - The technical committee needs to tweak the sensitivity levels and risk factors in the system.
- - The system should run for a month or two for observation before any decisions are made to lock in values.

CONCLUSION

to join us in this meeting, I appreciate it very much. So basically, I think we are getting close if we are not almost there. So this meeting is actually to discuss and find out how the interface between Publican and Ghana Link. So this morning, Ghana Link, both Ghana Link and the Publican are going to share with us what the expectation would be come Monday. So welcome once again. Yeah, thank you. Thank you very much, Madam. So Publican and Ghana Link, I think Ghana Link will start first with the data flow and then Publican will pick up to let us know if they are receiving the data and everything is moving on nicely. And then Publican will then share with us the return data to Ghana Link. And Ghana Link will also let us know if they are able to receive it. Okay, thank you very much, Sir Kofi. So I'll start, but pardon me, I don't have a presentation to show. I didn't know I would go like this, but let me give you a brief. I'll start with as was, and then as is known. And then the to be. So as was was, in December, we connected with Publican and we were sharing data with them. The challenge is, they were connected to our old data center. So there was some lag in the transmission of data when we received transactions in ICOMS. Kofi, please, am I audible? Hello, Kofi, please, am I audible? Sir Kofi, no bulls, am I audible? Yes, you are. Okay, sorry, sorry. Okay, so this was a bit challenging. Publican reached out to us that the delay wasn't helping. And we explained to them that it's because we had challenges with our old data center. And we were connected to our new data center. So that was the, as it was, as it was was, although they were connected, we had delays in transmission. And then also, the data was not so consistent, according to the reports they gave us. But then from January, we moved to our new data center and they were still connected to our old data center. Peruse their data, that would account for why the data was not flowing from January. Now the assets now is, we have worked together with Publican to connect them to our new data center. And then we have agreed on some data structure for us to be able to send them the data in real time. There are, we are still like, just a little bit away from normalizing because I saw a report yesterday where they said some of the values, because of the way we structured the data, it is not the best, or we are rounding up the data. So we will get that one done within the next 30 minutes. And with that being done, that means we'll be receiving data from Publican. We will peruse that data. But then Publican, they've not confirmed to us yet if they are receiving the data, but then they have confirmed that they are connected and they can see the data and they will be able to work with it. So that is the assets now. Now that to be scenario is,

for us to get that data into the clearance process or the logic flow of icons, which would have to be discussed, right? We will share the decisions with Customs. Customs will tell us how to make it available or how to let it add up to the decision flow or the logic in icons. So that is it, and that is where we want to be. But for now, we are tightly connected. I mean, and then we are exchanging data. Thank you very much. Okay, so with us, please, is Jacob, the head of R&D, Yaniv, the program manager, and our research director. So everyone is aligned. We got the information and the connectivity module on Thursday. We have worked through the weekend in order to enable the connectivity and the data intake and output with GhanaLink. Actually, Jacob and Dr. Kobi have aligned everything through the weekend. We have two or three small technical alignments. I don't know if everyone needs to be on, but we will gladly share it. And once it is done, as Dr. Kobi said, we will be able, once GhanaLink will open the stream of the shipments. And as I understand, it will be in the next hour we will be able to view them, to analyze, and to return to the icons, and to validate with Dr. Kobi that everything is presented and returned without any trouble. Is it okay, Dr. Kobi and Kofi? Do you approve? Yes. Okay, so let me just summarize what we just heard from you and to make sure we all understand you perfectly. So the first part is data is moving from GhanaLink to Publican confirmed? Yes, we need to establish it because we need to see the stream of shipments coming in. Yes. Yes. Okay, so the data confirmation is that. Now, return data from Publican to GhanaLink. Have you finished and agreed on the data fields that would be communicated back to? Some of the questions, I know the answer, but I just want the committee members to also be addressed. That's why I'm asking them. So have you agreed on the data fields to be communicated from Publican to GhanaLink? Yes, the format and everything is established. We need two small fixes from Dr. Kobi, but it is very small, about the size of a field, yes. Okay, so now that is confirmed, and there is also a connection to send that return data back to GhanaLink? Yes. Very good. So all we are left with is for you guys to do the small fixes and to get the display running. Yeah, and of course, for ICAMS to start streams the shipments from their site, as Dr. Kobi mentioned. Very good, okay. So Dr. Kobi and Amir, maybe one after the other, how, when do we expect this small fixes to be done for the data to stream? We will be also- Can we get some updates? We can speak about it now. It is two small questions, and then Dr. Kobi will answer about how, what is the effort in order to change that. Okay. So Dr. Kobi, I think this is up to you now. Yes, like I said, it is, I mean, it is not a major thing, although because, so this is what's happening. Just to set a

context, right, and to let everybody appreciate what is being done, it is not that we are, like, they are not sending the data. The data is being sent, right? But in computing, if you don't set the data type right, it will sometimes automatically round up the figure. So, for example, let's say, for example, thousand cities, 0.01 PESWES. You know, like, I mean, 0.01 PESWES, if you take it as just that one, it seems significant, but if you take a million of that, it becomes a problem. So the system data type is automatically ignoring the decimals for noun, which is just, it wasn't intentional. It's just by design of how we were receiving the data they would send, because the ones that we are sending to them, we send it with it, but then the ones that they are sending it to us, when it gets into the system, the system will just automatically convert it into, like, I mean, the next round of figure. Exactly. So that change, that is a change that we need to do. And the way that's determined, like I said, within the next 30 minutes, let's say after this meeting, I saw the message some few minutes ago, that when they notified us, correct that one. So that one will be done in the next 30 minutes, it should be done, and I will discuss with Kobi. Kobi would, as in Kobi from Publican, if he confirms that everything is okay, then we are done over there, and then we can just proceed. So it is something minor, but I guess, because, I mean, we are the, let's say, oversee committee, I'm just letting you know what is still outstanding, by something very insignificant. Yes, Dr. Kobi, we need also to align the time zone, the UTC. Oh, okay, okay, okay. That is why I said within 30 minutes. So from, I don't know your time now, but let's say in our time now, it is almost 10.47. So let's say 30 minutes from now will be like, let's say 11.13. Thereabouts. So you just add 30 minutes to your time now, it should be fine. Okay, no problem. Okay, so thank you guys very much. So if I understand, the two minor problems we are having is one, the rounding up of the figures, correcting that, and also the time zone that I think you are just giving them information on right now. So, Madam Chair, if you will permit, what I would request is, now that we are very clear, ah, Kobi, another thing we need to look at, the data presentation. I thought we resolved that issue that you are supposed to make it available to CTSV, for them to be able to use it for their assessment. And then secondly, later, we will do a connection with all the MDAs and the inspection officers too. Sorry, can you restate that? So what I'm saying is, the data presentation, there were supposed to be two groups of people who will be assessing the information. The first one would be for CTSV, who will be using it to do evaluation and assessment. The second one will be the officers doing the inspection and also the various MDAs who are giving approvals and permits. Yes, I mean, so in principle, that is the

discussion. But the part that I said, that to be part would be, we would have to maybe discuss with the TFG team as in, you know, like, at which point do we show it to them and what does it do? Is it just, so the part where I said that to be logic is, is it that it is more or less like a reference screen where they just see, or is it going to like be some logic that maybe the officer is supposed to use it and there are some nitty-gritties that like detail, that details that we have to discuss technically. Okay, so doc, this committee is the committee that will take that decision. So nobody else is coming to give you any updates or any information again. Okay, okay, pardon me, I didn't know about that, sorry. Yes, so for now, what we are planning on doing is, you know, it's an AI and it needs to learn. So for now, it's just going to be a reference data set that would be available to CTSB for them to confirm and use in doing the evaluation. But then over time, that's why I'm saying for the implementation study, it should just be a reference. So they will see it as a reference, giving information on anomalies to cargo description to aid officers in their evaluation. No, but hold on, let me get, this is just for like my own curiosity. No problem. Okay, so let's look at data flow. So the transacting comes in and then the transaction comes in. Okay, I think I've answered my own question. So that part of the design is where, no, I was going to say once, let's say we send it to them and they send us like the AI values, right? Yes. How does the AI learn from that? But then I remember that we were discussing that we would have to notify them that it was actually paid. And so the AI can learn from that, that return part. So that is another part, maybe I'm just marking down, we'll have to check and work on. Yes, perfectly, perfectly. Okay. So, Mr. Kobi, with that understanding, you don't need any information from the technical committee again to- No, I do, I do for that to be. The other, that is why I'm saying that, okay, this part is the discussion with, let's say public and the one you just said. But what I'm asking now is, from, let's say, CTSBN. Yes. Are we going to present it like how you used to do the, let's say the reference pricing? You know, the reference price database or the external verification, the data comes in and they can just see and use it for referencing. Is that- Yes. Is that what we are agreeing it to be? That is what I want to know. Or is it automatic that when it comes, the officer should be locked to that value? That's the question I'm asking. Yes. So, Madam Chair would throw more light, but the understanding that we have is that this is a new system that we are deploying. It's an AI. It now has to learn our structures and our policies to make it more efficient. We don't want to start the project and then a lot of objections will come and make a lot of noise on it. So for a start, it's going to just be a reference price for CTSB officers to refer to.

Over time, when it's able to learn and now become very perfect, then we can take a decision as to lock it into the system for officers not to have a chance to amend it. But for a start, maybe for the first two or three months, it's going to just act as a reference pricing system. And committee members- That is well noted, but maybe the committee will throw a little more light on it or we are good to go. So, back with you, Madam Chair. Okay. Okay. I'm going to reverse Mary. I have so, like Kofi just mentioned, for the stats, it should be a reference guide, not locked up values. Because we are now testing the capabilities. We've tested the public and we know what it can do. But then since we are going to go live and other things, we would need to, from the stats, if we just make it a reference guide, then after three months, when we've done some monitoring and evaluation, then we can take a fair decision as to whether we can go ahead and start locking values so that it doesn't get abused. So, I think for the stats, it should just be a reference guide. Actually, if I may add, the database structure, what we have did with Gardaling, with Dr. Kofi, enables this method of thinking because we don't replace any log, we just add one. Dr. Kofi, please confirm. Yes, please, it is. And also to add up to that, the updates that we had to do has been done. So, you can also confirm now and we know that the deliverable has been completed. So, now we accept the decimal places as well. Okay, we're checking. Wonderful, this is very good. And thank you very much, Madam Chair. So, for those who may be joined later, Madam Rosemary is the Chairman of the Technical Committee. So, every decision, she has to locate before any decision can be taken. So, just to note that. So, now that we are very clear on how the return data would be populated and distributed, if Madam Chair would permit, I would propose that we allow Gardaling and then Publican to have their internal purpose meeting. I would call them back around two o'clock to confirm if everything has been set up and we can now be seeing the display on the icon system, the return data. And then maybe we can have a finalizing meeting around five or six o'clock, which will be communicated to the group to have a look at the finished product so that by Monday morning, we won't have any surprises. And Madam Chair, if you permit that and if everybody's okay with it. Hello, Kofi, I want to come in. Yes, yeah. Kofi, yeah, from what you just said and then the Chairman also agreed to it, if you are going to take it up for the reference level. So, let's say in case a declaration has come in, a declaration, the AI has gone to the websites and picked up the actual invoice value and brought it in. Now, it's going to put the actual invoice value with all the values from other places. So now, all of them are going to be a reference values. So now, you are leaving it for the city of the police officer to now to

choose whatever value he wants from those reference value or the actual invoice value. That is what is bugging my mind now. Because if we can get the authentic invoice value and any other value in addition, why don't we use the invoice value? This is my question. Yeah, can I come here, Joanne? I like the fact that you mentioned that's the actual. So if it's actual, then obviously it's the actual, which then becomes the transaction value that will be picked. But when it cannot reach the actual invoice and then it just gives us values within that region or from the exporter to importers, then we would have to, that is where I think when we're developing the SOPs, we came up with some form of where there's the need to escalate to a next level for approval. That is when, because the last time we were trying to look at the median value and then all those things. So actually, the median value was supposed to just one value, then it will be locked. But we are starting with the same thing. There's going to be a challenge because. If it actually is able to bring the actual invoice, then obviously that is what would happen. Yeah, exactly. So we have to look at it very well. If it can bring the actual value, then that actual value should be locked up. The one that is not an actual, then that one will go into reference. Okay, yeah. That's the way we have to look at it, right? Yeah, so from a technical standpoint, I think, then I agree with what Kofi is saying. You know, at least now, we would observe it and then see. And then based on that, let's say after some time. So even if it's bringing the actual one, like observing it for a while, I mean, a week or two, wouldn't spoil anything. So let's see how it works. Okay. So I agree that we don't do any locking for now. And from what Kofi said, to also prevent abuse or backlash and all that, we can let it run seamlessly behind the scenes and then observe to use it and give recommendations. And we can also fine tune it and make it better. Okay, so just to add some information for Gerald. So Gerald, the whole idea is you are starting something that people are already agitating over. So we don't want to rush quickly and lock things in and then now they have a reason to complain when especially they may have genuine reasons to contest their case. Secondly, the technical committee has some extra work to do. We are supposed to go back and tweak the sensitivity levels and the risk factors that are in the system. We can add on, we can take out of the system. We have not done that. So it will not be fair to leave the system like this when we know that certain policy decisions have been taken by our bosses to weigh on certain issues. For instance, for vehicles. You know, for vehicles, we use the home value. So what if public goes to check the system and realizes that the home value we are using is actually lower and the person really bought it higher and then we bring it in. It would then abuse the law

because the law says you should use the home value. It doesn't matter how much the person bought it for. So if it's okay with you, what we would do with this, let's run the system now for at least a month or two, the technical committee now will have free space to now go and look at the sensitivity level, the risk levels and all the engine things that we need to configure. Then after we are very certain that the data we are getting now, we can stand by it and we can argue with the office. And that would even give us information on the decision of offices against public. If we do the analysis from the back end and we realize that officer's decisions have always been wrong, then we have a justifiable cause to say, okay, now we're going to lock it in. If you have any additional information, then petition and go to the approval people to take a decision. And that's my submission, please. Thank you. Yeah. All right. When they say lock, I'm not saying they should lock automatic the value to whatever has been declared. Or I'm saying that that lock, like it will be available, this is the actual value for, let's say a kilo of rice. Okay. A kilo of rice declared by the importer is less than 0.50 cents. Now the actual that came is one kilo, \$1 per kilo. So that \$1 per kilo is the invoice value for that. So that should be available for the city officer to use. That's what I'm saying. Yeah. I agree with that. Yes. That is it. Yes. Yes. You are very right. You are very, very right. So that's what I'm getting. For him to use. I'm not saying to just lock it up to the UE. No. Oh, okay. So that eventually the AI will build a database for the reference. You understand? Aha. Eventually the AI is going to build a database for the references. This is the way I'm looking at it. Right. Thank you. I think we are on the same page. Thank you so much. Right. Okay. So, okay. So thank you guys very much. Madam, if Madam Chair permits, we'll call the meeting to leave. And then I would follow up on the call at three o'clock. So for me, it looks like someone wanted to talk. I think I saw Alphonse. Alphonse wanted to ask a question or ask something else. So if we can allow Alphonse to. Commissioner, forgive me. My name, I think my, sorry, sorry. Commissioner, please. That's okay. So, yes. This issue of determination, value determination, I think we might be a little objective about it and go by the rules. Just like, let's not impose anything or let's not make any significant changes to what exists today. Today, it is because they don't have information. But now that this AI is coming in, they will have information. And once they have information, they can use all the rules available to ensure that they do the right thing. And they know the consequences for not doing the right thing. But then if you draw lines for them, they would go by your lines. And ultimately, I don't think it will sit well. Again. Yes. Again, you must look at the public sentiments immediately. So don't let

something else is what is pushing you off. No. The officer's decision must prevail for that. It should prevail. Let us do the back end and do whatever we want to do to see. Because Kofi was saying something about the vehicle section. It is in a certain way. So if you don't allow the officers and you try to micromanage them, they'll follow you to the bush and they'll point at you. You are very right, Commissioner. Commissioner, I couldn't agree with you more. I think we've all learnt our lesson with implementing policies in Ghana. And personally, with the help of Madam Chair, we always want to err on the side of caution to make sure the system works. If we have enough evidence to prove our case, then we can take whatever decision that we want. But until that, we allow the officer to use the information as they see fit. And they know they're also accountable. And that's why we have the technical committee and PCA and TACA all at the background, also having access to the same data. So if an officer, you think that you could ignore the information from Publican, PCA will pick it up because they will see all the exceptional cases where the decision of Publican was overridden. And they can also interrogate those decisions and go after for revenues to be collected. The opportunity is it won't be archived data, it will be real data where within a week that a decision is taken, an officer can also look at it from that side and review it. Thank you very much. Copy one thing, one thing, one thing I beg. Copy the presentation. We didn't complete, how are they going to see the data? Are they going to see it in ICOMS? Like you log on to ICOMS, you go there, are you going to click a link to go into Publican or the data, you didn't mention all this. Okay. Oh, sorry. I think we've had a discussion on that earlier. So let me just reiterate it. So what is going to happen is on the page for CTSB, they will have another tab that will be Publican information tab. That will give you all a similar replication of the declaration you have made. So if there are any changes, it would highlight those ones on the Publican tab. For you the officer to see that maybe the value is wrong. So you need, these are the proposed values. The description is wrong. These are, this is the proposed description. The HS is wrong. This is the proposed HS. The weight is wrong. This is the proposed weight. So you'll see everything. So it's for the officer to either replicate that data and amend the BOE for the imported data.